

CLOUDKART

Refund Policy

Billing & Payments Knowledge Base

Defines refund eligibility windows, exclusions, request channels, processing timelines, and escalation paths for chargebacks, failed transactions, and duplicate charges across all CloudKart product categories.

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1. Purpose and Scope

CloudKart issues refunds for eligible purchases made through the CloudKart storefront, mobile app, or partner reseller checkout, subject to the product type, time elapsed since purchase, and usage of the purchased item or service. This document defines what is eligible, the review process, and expected timelines so that support agents and the support chatbot can give customers consistent, accurate answers.

Refunds are evaluated against three factors: the refund window for the product category, whether the order has already been fulfilled or downloaded, and whether the customer's account is in good standing. Orders flagged for fraud review are paused until the fraud team clears them, regardless of how much time remains in the refund window.

Quick Answer

Most digital purchases can be refunded within 14 days of purchase if usage is below the eligibility threshold. Physical goods follow the 30-day return window described in the Shipping & Returns documentation instead of this policy.

Agents handling refund requests should always begin by confirming what was purchased before quoting a window or eligibility outcome, since the rules differ meaningfully between subscriptions, one-time add-ons, API credits, and physical goods. Quoting the wrong category's window is one of the most common sources of escalation, since the customer will hold the agent to whatever was stated first.

Worked Examples

Scenario: A customer emails asking for 'a refund' with no other detail.

Resolution: Ask which order or product the request relates to before applying any policy; do not assume subscription rules apply by default.

Scenario: A customer purchased a Pro plan 10 days ago and has used it lightly.

Resolution: This falls under the monthly subscription window; check usage percentage before approving or denying.

2. Refund Eligibility by Product Category

Eligibility depends on what was purchased. The table below summarizes the standard refund windows by product category. These windows apply from the original purchase timestamp shown on the customer's invoice, not from the date the customer contacts support.

Product Category	Refund Window	Usage Limit	Notes
Subscription – monthly	14 days	<20% of billing cycle used	Pro-rated refund if partially used and under threshold
Subscription – annual	30 days	<10% of billing cycle used	After day 30 only future renewals can be cancelled
One-time digital add-ons	14 days	Not yet activated	Activated add-ons non-refundable except for defects
API usage credits	7 days	<5% of credits consumed	Bulk packs via invoice follow custom contract terms
Physical merchandise	See Shipping Policy	N/A	Refer to Returns & Exchanges document

Customers on legacy pricing plans (any plan purchased before March 2024) follow the refund terms attached to their original order confirmation email, which take precedence over the table above if more generous.

The refund window and the usage limit are evaluated together, not independently. A purchase can be within the time window but still ineligible due to usage, and conversely a lightly-used purchase can be ineligible if the time window has lapsed. Agents must check both conditions before giving the customer a final answer, since confirming only one leads to promises that later have to be walked back.

Worked Examples

Scenario: Annual Pro plan, refund requested on day 25, usage at 7%.

Resolution: Both conditions met (within 30 days, under 10% usage); process as eligible.

Scenario: API credit pack purchased 5 days ago, 8% of credits consumed.

Resolution: Exceeds the 5% usage limit; not auto-eligible — explain and offer the exception form.

3. Non-Refundable Items and Exclusions

Some purchases are excluded from standard refunds because they involve third-party costs CloudKart cannot recover, or because the nature of the product makes a refund impractical once delivered.

- Gift cards and store credit balances — once issued, non-refundable but do not expire.
- Custom enterprise contracts negotiated outside the standard checkout are governed by the signed order form, not this policy.
- Promotional or trial-derived subscriptions that converted to paid plans are refundable only for the first billing cycle after conversion.
- Domain name registrations and similar pass-through third-party services are non-refundable once the registration request has been submitted to the registrar.
- Add-on services consumed immediately upon purchase (e.g., expedited processing fees) are non-refundable once the expedited action has been performed.

Important

Agents should never promise an exception to these exclusions verbally. Exceptions must be escalated to a Billing Team Lead using the Refund Exception form.

Exclusions exist because CloudKart either cannot recover the underlying cost or because the product has been delivered and consumed in a way that cannot be undone. When a customer pushes back, agents should explain the underlying reason rather than simply citing the policy; this materially improves customer satisfaction even when the outcome doesn't change.

Worked Examples

Scenario: Customer wants a refund on store credit they received but never spent.

Resolution: Store credit is non-refundable; explain it remains available indefinitely for any future purchase.

Scenario: Trial converted to paid Pro; customer requests refund 40 days after conversion.

Resolution: Only the first billing cycle after conversion is eligible; 40 days exceeds a monthly cycle — not eligible under standard policy.

4. How to Request a Refund

Customers can request a refund through three channels. Self-service requests are fastest and are recommended whenever the customer is eligible under the standard policy above.

- 1 Self-service: Account Settings > Billing History > select order > **Request Refund**. Eligible orders refund automatically; ineligible orders route to manual review.
- 2 Chat or chatbot request: The chatbot verifies eligibility using the order lookup tool. If eligible it submits the refund automatically; otherwise it creates a ticket tagged **billing-refund-review**.
- 3 Email or phone: Agent verifies the order, checks eligibility against Section 2, and processes the refund manually through the Billing Console.

All refund requests, regardless of channel, must include the order ID or invoice number. Requests without this information should prompt a follow-up question rather than a denial.

Agents and the chatbot should mention the self-service path proactively even when a customer reaches out through chat or email, since it sets the expectation that future requests can be resolved without waiting for a human response. This also keeps ticket volume down during peak support periods.

Worked Examples

Scenario: Customer emails asking for a refund but never provides an order number.

Resolution: Reply asking for the order ID or the email used at checkout before taking any further action; do not search broadly across the account without it.

Scenario: Customer says the self-service refund button is greyed out.

Resolution: Usually means the order is outside the eligible window or category; verify eligibility manually using Section 2 before escalating as a bug.

5. Refund Processing Timelines

Once approved, refunds are issued back to the original payment method whenever possible. The table below shows expected timelines for funds to appear, which differ from the time CloudKart takes to approve the refund internally.

Payment Method	CloudKart Processing	Bank/Provider Posting Time
Credit or debit card	Instant to 1 business day	3–10 business days
PayPal	Instant to 1 business day	1–3 business days
Bank transfer (ACH)	1–2 business days	3–5 business days
Mobile wallet	Instant to 1 business day	1–5 business days
Store credit (customer's choice)	Instant	Available immediately

It is worth distinguishing clearly, when speaking with a customer, between the moment CloudKart approves and issues a refund and the moment funds settle back into the customer's account. Many 'my refund never arrived' tickets are cases where the refund was issued correctly but the bank had not yet posted it; checking the Billing Console first avoids unnecessary duplicate refund attempts.

Worked Examples

Scenario: Customer says it has been 4 business days and the refund hasn't appeared.

Resolution: Within the normal card posting window; reassure the customer and provide the expected timeframe rather than escalating.

Scenario: Billing Console shows refund issued 15 business days ago, still not on the card.

Resolution: Exceeds the normal window; advise the customer to contact their bank directly with the refund transaction ID — CloudKart's portion of the process is complete.

6. Refunds to Alternative Payment Methods

When a refund cannot be issued to the original payment method (for example, an expired or cancelled card), CloudKart offers two alternatives.

- **Store credit:** Issued instantly and applicable to any future purchase. Recommended as the default alternative since it requires no new banking details.
- **Manual bank transfer:** Available on request for amounts over \$50. Requires the customer to submit verified bank details through the secure billing portal, never through chat or email.

Security Notice

Agents must never request card numbers, CVV codes, or full bank account numbers directly in chat, email, or over the phone. Always direct customers to the secure billing portal for any payment detail collection.

Store credit is recommended as the default alternative not only because it is faster, but because it avoids the security exposure of collecting fresh banking details in an unverified channel. When a customer insists on a bank transfer, still route them through the secure portal rather than attempting to facilitate the transfer manually.

Worked Examples

Scenario: Customer's card expired and they want their \$15 refund via bank transfer.

Resolution: Offer store credit as the default — instant and avoids collecting banking details for a small amount. Offer the portal path if they insist on a transfer.

Scenario: A \$200 refund customer insists on a bank transfer instead of store credit.

Resolution: Direct them to the secure billing portal; do not collect account numbers in chat.

7. Chargebacks and Payment Disputes

Refunds for disputed or chargeback-related transactions follow a different process from voluntary refund requests, since a bank or card network is already involved.

If a customer says they intend to file a chargeback, agents should encourage them to request a standard refund first, since refunds resolve faster and do not freeze the customer's account. Once a chargeback is formally filed with the bank, CloudKart's dispute team takes over and standard refund processing is paused for that order until the dispute resolves.

Scenario	Recommended Agent Action
Customer threatens chargeback but hasn't filed	Offer standard refund immediately if eligible
Chargeback already filed with bank	Do not issue refund; escalate to Disputes Team with tag dispute-active
Chargeback resolved in CloudKart's favour	No refund owed; inform customer of outcome
Chargeback resolved in customer's favour	Account may be flagged; escalate to Billing Team Lead before re-enabling services

Encouraging customers toward a standard refund before a chargeback is filed is not just faster for the customer; it also avoids the chargeback fee CloudKart incurs from the payment processor regardless of the dispute's outcome, and it avoids the temporary account restrictions that often accompany an active dispute.

Worked Examples

Scenario: Customer says 'I'm going to dispute this with my bank' while still in chat.

Resolution: Offer an immediate standard refund if eligible; resolves the issue faster and avoids account restrictions.

Scenario: Account shows an active chargeback flag.

Resolution: Do not issue a refund through the standard flow; escalate to Disputes with tag dispute-active and inform the customer the case is under review.

8. Failed and Duplicate Transactions

Failed or duplicate transactions are not refunds in the traditional sense since the customer should not have been charged at all, or was charged more than once due to a processing error. These cases should be resolved faster than standard refund requests.

- 1 Confirm the duplicate or erroneous charge using the order ID and the payment processor transaction log, searchable by card last-4 digits and date.
- 2 If two charges map to a single completed order, reverse the duplicate immediately; no review period is required for clear duplicates.
- 3 If a charge appears with no matching order (failed transaction still showing as charged), escalate to Billing Engineering using tag **payment-orphan-charge**.
- 4 Always reverse duplicate or erroneous charges in full; partial reversals are not permitted for this category of issue.

Tip for the Support Chatbot

Queries containing 'charged twice', 'double charged', or 'charged but order failed' should be routed to `billing_faq` and `refund_policy` retrievers and treated as high priority, since they often indicate a processing error rather than a standard refund request.

Duplicate and orphaned charges erode customer trust quickly because the customer did nothing wrong, so resolving them promptly and without friction matters more than for a typical refund request. Agents should avoid asking a customer to 'wait and see if it resolves itself' — a clearly duplicated or orphaned charge should be reversed proactively once confirmed in the transaction log.

Worked Examples

Scenario: Customer shows two identical \$39 charges from the same minute.

Resolution: Confirm both map to the same order; reverse the duplicate immediately without requiring further review.

Scenario: Customer was charged \$39 but account still shows the Starter plan.

Resolution: Orphaned charge — escalate to Billing Engineering with tag `payment-orphan-charge` rather than treating it as a standard refund.

9. Quick Reference: Refund Decision Flow

This quick reference summarises the full refund decision flow in a format designed for rapid consultation during a customer interaction.

Decision Flow: Is This Refund Eligible?

- 1 Identify the product category (subscription, add-on, API credits, physical).
- 2 Check the purchase date against the refund window for that category (Section 2).
- 3 If within the window, check the usage percentage against the usage limit.
- 4 If both conditions are met, approve via the Billing Console or self-service portal.
- 5 If either condition fails, check whether a Refund Exception is warranted; if so, submit the exception form to the Billing Team Lead — do not approve unilaterally.
- 6 For failed or duplicate charges, skip the eligibility check entirely and proceed directly to reversal or Billing Engineering escalation (Section 8).

Question	Yes → Next Step	No → Action
Is the purchase within the refund window?	Check usage limit	Deny or escalate for exception
Is usage below the limit?	Approve refund	Deny or escalate for exception
Is there an active chargeback?	Escalate to Disputes	Process normally
Is this a duplicate/failed charge?	Reverse immediately	Standard refund flow

Agents who regularly consult this quick reference typically resolve billing contacts faster and with fewer escalations. The most common error is approving a refund without checking both the time window AND the usage threshold — always verify both before confirming eligibility to a customer.

Appendix A: Refund Status Codes

Internal status codes used in the Billing Console when processing refunds.

Status Code	Meaning
RF-100	Refund auto-approved, eligible under standard policy
RF-210	Refund pending manual review (usage threshold exceeded)
RF-310	Refund denied, non-refundable item
RF-410	Refund paused, fraud review in progress
RF-520	Refund issued as store credit per customer selection
RF-610	Refund blocked, active chargeback on order